

FBLA — Introduction to Business Procedures

Supplementary vocabulary & practice questions for deeper review

Generated June 27, 2026 · 87 terms · 52 questions

Note: This is **supplementary** material, researched from the FBLA Introduction to Business Procedures scope and standard business references. It is **NOT** taken from your original study document — it expands on the same topics.

Contents: Part 1 — Vocabulary & Concepts (10 topics, 87 terms) · Part 2 — Practice Questions with answers (52 questions)

Part 1 · Vocabulary & Concepts

Term → definition, grouped by topic.

Communication Process

The path a message travels: Sender → Encode → Message → Channel → Receiver → Decode → Feedback. 'Noise' is any interference that distorts the message.

Nonverbal Communication

Messages sent without words — body language, facial expressions, eye contact, gestures, posture, tone. Often outweighs the spoken words when the two conflict.

Feedback

The receiver's response that tells the sender whether the message was understood — it closes the communication loop.

Modified Block Format

Letter format where the date, complimentary close, and signature begin at the CENTER, while paragraphs stay left-aligned and un-indented. (Full block = everything left-aligned.)

Salutation

The greeting line of a letter (e.g., "Dear Ms. Lee:"). In business letters it is followed by a colon.

Complimentary Close

The polite sign-off before the signature (e.g., "Sincerely,"). Only the first word is capitalized.

Inside Address

The recipient's name, title, and full address, placed above the salutation in a business letter.

Reference Initials

Initials at the bottom of a letter showing who composed vs. typed it (author in CAPS, typist in lowercase: JL/mr).

Mehrabian's 7-38-55 Rule

When a speaker's words and feelings conflict, listeners take ~7% of the meaning from words, 38% from tone of voice, and 55% from body language — so nonverbal cues dominate emotional messages.

Active vs Passive Voice

Active voice ('The team met the goal') is clearer and more direct than passive ('The goal was met') — preferred in most business writing.

Blank Endorsement

Just the payee's signature on the back of a check — makes it payable to ANYONE holding it, so it's the least secure.

Special (Full) Endorsement

"Pay to the order of [name]" plus your signature — transfers the check to a specific person.

Restrictive Endorsement

Limits how a check can be used, e.g., "For Deposit Only" — the most secure endorsement for mailing or depositing.

Cashier's Check

A check drawn on and guaranteed by the bank's own funds — more secure than a personal check.

Money Order

A prepaid instrument for a set amount, used when a personal check isn't accepted; no bank account required.

Deposit Slip

A form listing the cash and checks being added to an account, used to record a deposit.

Debit vs Credit (banking)

A debit decreases your account balance (money out); a credit increases it (money in).

Income Statement

Reports revenue and expenses over a PERIOD to show profit or loss (net income). Also called a P&L statement.

Statement of Cash Flows

Shows cash moving in and out over a period across operating, investing, and financing activities.

Gross Pay vs Net Pay

Gross pay = total earnings before deductions; net pay = take-home pay after taxes and withholdings.

LAN

Local Area Network — connects devices in one location (home, office, school). Fast and relatively secure.

WAN

Wide Area Network — connects devices across large distances/multiple locations. The internet is the largest WAN.

MAN

Metropolitan Area Network — spans a city or campus; larger than a LAN, smaller than a WAN.

RAM vs ROM

RAM = temporary working memory, erased when powered off (volatile). ROM = permanent built-in memory that isn't erased (non-volatile).

Input vs Output Devices

Input sends data IN (keyboard, mouse, scanner, mic). Output sends data OUT (monitor, printer, speakers).

CPU

Central Processing Unit — the "brain" of the computer that executes instructions.

Phishing

A scam using fake emails or websites to trick people into revealing passwords or financial information.

Firewall

Hardware or software that blocks unauthorized access to a network while allowing legitimate traffic through.

Cloud Computing

Storing and accessing data and programs over the internet instead of on a local hard drive.

Bit vs Byte

A bit is the smallest unit of data (0 or 1); a byte = 8 bits and typically stores one character.

Law of Demand

As price rises, quantity demanded falls (and vice versa) — the demand curve slopes downward.

Law of Supply

As price rises, quantity supplied rises — the supply curve slopes upward.

Equilibrium Price

The price at which quantity supplied equals quantity demanded; the market "clears."

Perfect Competition

Many small firms selling identical products with no control over price (e.g., commodity farming).

Monopoly

A single seller controls the entire market with no close substitutes — maximum price control.

Oligopoly

A market dominated by a few large firms (e.g., airlines, cell carriers).

Monopolistic Competition

Many firms selling similar but differentiated products (e.g., restaurants, clothing brands).

Opportunity Cost

The value of the next-best alternative given up when you make a choice.

Inflation

A sustained rise in the general price level, which reduces purchasing power.

Fiscal vs Monetary Policy

Fiscal = government taxing and spending (Congress). Monetary = controlling the money supply and interest rates (the Federal Reserve).

Types of Unemployment

Frictional (between jobs), Structural (skills mismatch), Cyclical (recession), Seasonal (time of year).

GDP vs GNP

GDP = output produced within a country's borders. GNP = output by a country's citizens, wherever located.

Parliamentary Procedure

Rules (Robert's Rules of Order) for running orderly meetings using motions, seconds, and votes.

Motion

A formal proposal made in a meeting for the group to take action; must be "seconded" before discussion.

Span of Control

The number of employees a manager directly supervises. Wide span = flat org; narrow span = tall org.

Chain of Command

The formal line of authority showing who reports to whom, from top to bottom.

Delegation

Assigning authority and responsibility for a task to a subordinate while remaining accountable for the outcome.

Dress Code Hierarchy

From most to least formal: Business Formal → Business Professional → Business Casual → Casual. Match the level to the industry and occasion (client meeting vs. ordinary day).

Smart Casual

A step above business casual: polished, put-together pieces (e.g., blazer with dark jeans) — neat but not suited-up.

Visitor Badge & Sign-In Log

A security control: visitors sign in, receive a badge, and are escorted. Creates an audit trail and supports building safety.

Meeting Types

Common formats: informational (share updates), decision-making (reach a choice), brainstorming (generate ideas), status/stand-up (quick progress check), and one-on-one.

Career 7 terms

Chronological Resume

Lists work history in reverse time order (most recent first) — best for steady, related experience.

Functional Resume

Organizes by skills rather than dates — good for career changers or those with gaps in work history.

Cover Letter

A letter accompanying a resume that introduces you and explains why you fit the specific job.

References

People who can vouch for your work and character; always ask permission before listing them.

STAR Method

A way to answer behavioral interview questions: describe the Situation, the Task, the Action you took, and the Result you achieved.

Hard vs Soft Skills

Hard skills are teachable/technical (Excel, accounting); soft skills are interpersonal (communication, teamwork). Employers want both.

Transferable Skills

Skills that carry across roles and industries (writing, problem-solving, project management) — key when changing careers or explaining gaps.

Records 3 terms

Cross-Reference

A notation placed in a file pointing to where a record is actually stored (when it could be filed under more than one name).

Geographic Filing

Arranging records by location (country, state, city) — useful for sales territories.

Subject Filing

Arranging records by topic or category rather than by name or number.

ADDIE Model

Instructional-design framework for building training: Analyze → Design → Develop → Implement → Evaluate. (Kirkpatrick evaluates training; ADDIE builds it.)

Kirkpatrick — 4 Levels

Evaluates training in order: 1) Reaction (did they like it?) 2) Learning (did they gain knowledge/skills?) 3) Behavior (are they applying it on the job?) 4) Results (did it improve business outcomes?).

360-Degree Feedback

Performance feedback collected from multiple sources around an employee — peers, subordinates, managers, and self — for a well-rounded view.

Orientation vs Onboarding

Orientation is the short initial welcome (paperwork, tour, intros). Onboarding is the longer process of fully integrating and ramping a new hire over weeks/months.

Mentoring vs Coaching

Mentoring is a longer-term relationship guiding overall career growth. Coaching is shorter-term and focused on improving a specific skill or performance gap.

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Motivation theory: needs are met bottom-up — Physiological → Safety → Social/Belonging → Esteem → Self-Actualization.

Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

Hygiene factors (salary, job security, conditions) only prevent dissatisfaction; motivators (recognition, growth, achievement) are what actually drive satisfaction.

McGregor's Theory X / Theory Y

Theory X assumes employees dislike work and need close control; Theory Y assumes they're self-motivated and thrive with responsibility.

SMART vs OKRs

SMART defines one well-formed goal (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound). OKRs pair an ambitious Objective with 3–5 measurable Key Results.

9-Box Grid

A talent-review matrix plotting employees on performance (x) vs. potential (y) to guide development and succession decisions.

Progressive Discipline

Escalating response to performance/conduct issues: verbal warning → written warning → suspension → termination, documented at each step.

Histogram

Shows the distribution/frequency of ONE continuous variable grouped into bins. Different from a bar chart, which compares discrete categories.

Gantt Chart

Horizontal bars mapping project tasks against a timeline — shows schedule, duration, and dependencies.

Area Chart

Like a line chart with the space below filled in — emphasizes the magnitude/volume of a trend over time.

Combo Chart

Combines two chart types (e.g., bars + a line) to display related data on different scales in one view.

Truncated Axis

When a chart's value axis doesn't start at zero, small differences look huge — a common way charts mislead. Always check the scale before drawing conclusions.

Data-Ink Ratio

Tufte's principle: maximize the ink that conveys real data and remove 'chartjunk' (heavy gridlines, 3-D effects, decoration).

CIA Triad

The core model of information security: Confidentiality (limit access), Integrity (keep data accurate/untampered), and Availability (keep it accessible when needed).

Zero Trust

A security model summarized as 'never trust, always verify' — every user and device must be authenticated and authorized, even inside the network.

Phishing → Spear Phishing → Whaling

Phishing casts a wide net; spear phishing targets a specific person; whaling targets a senior executive ('big fish'). More targeting = more convincing.

Symmetric vs Asymmetric Encryption

Symmetric uses ONE shared secret key (fast). Asymmetric uses a public/private KEY PAIR (you encrypt with the public key, decrypt with the private).

GDPR vs CCPA

GDPR is the EU's data-privacy law; CCPA is California's. Both give individuals rights over how their personal data is collected and used.

Incident Response (PICERL)

The lifecycle for handling a breach: Prepare → Identify → Contain → Eradicate → Recover → Lessons learned.

Penetration Test vs Vulnerability Scan

A vulnerability scan automatically lists known weaknesses; a penetration test has experts actively try to exploit them, like a real attacker.

Whistleblower Protection

Laws like Sarbanes-Oxley shield employees who report fraud or violations from workplace retaliation.

Defense in Depth

Layering multiple, overlapping security controls (firewall + MFA + encryption + training) so no single failure exposes the system.

Part 2 · Practice Questions & Answers

The ✓ marks the correct choice; the "Why" line explains it.

Communication 5 questions

1. The communication loop is closed when the receiver provides what?

1. Encoding
2. Feedback ✓ correct
3. Noise
4. A channel

Why: Feedback is the receiver's response that tells the sender the message was (or wasn't) understood — it closes the loop.

2. When a person's words and emotions conflict, which usually carries more meaning?

1. The spoken words
2. Nonverbal communication ✓ correct
3. The email subject line
4. The salutation

Why: Nonverbal cues (body language, tone, expression) tend to override the literal words when the two don't match.

3. In a business letter, the salutation is punctuated with a:

1. Comma
2. Colon ✓ correct
3. Semicolon
4. Period

Why: Business-letter salutations end with a colon (e.g., "Dear Ms. Lee:"). A comma is informal/personal.

4. In MODIFIED block format, which elements begin at the center of the page?

1. Every line
2. The date, complimentary close, and signature ✓ correct
3. Only the body paragraphs
4. The inside address

Why: Modified block centers the date, close, and signature while paragraphs stay left-aligned. Full block = everything left-aligned.

5. By Mehrabian's 7-38-55 rule, when words and feelings conflict, most meaning comes from:

1. The exact words (7%)
2. Tone of voice (38%)
3. Body language (55%) ✓ correct
4. The email subject line

Why: For emotionally charged messages, ~55% of meaning is body language, 38% tone, and only 7% the literal words.

6. Which endorsement is the MOST secure for mailing a check to be deposited?

1. Blank endorsement
2. Special endorsement

3. Restrictive endorsement ("For Deposit Only") ✓ correct

4. No endorsement

Why: A restrictive endorsement like "For Deposit Only" limits the check's use, making it safest if lost or stolen.

7. A blank endorsement on a check makes it:

1. Payable only to a named person

2. Payable to anyone who holds it ✓ correct

3. Impossible to cash
4. A cashier's check

Why: A blank endorsement is just the payee's signature — it makes the check payable to whoever holds it, so it's the least secure.

8. Which check is drawn on and guaranteed by the bank's own funds?

1. Personal check

2. Cashier's check ✓ correct

3. Post-dated check
4. Voided check

Why: A cashier's check is paid from the bank's funds and guaranteed by the bank — more secure than a personal check.

9. Which financial statement reports revenue and expenses over a PERIOD of time?

1. Balance sheet

2. Income statement ✓ correct

3. Deposit slip
4. Inventory list

Why: The income statement (P&L) shows revenue minus expenses over a period. The balance sheet is a point-in-time snapshot.

10. Net pay is best defined as:

1. Total earnings before deductions

2. Take-home pay after taxes and deductions ✓ correct

3. Only overtime earnings
4. Pay before bonuses

Why: Net pay = gross pay minus taxes and withholdings — the actual take-home amount.

11. Which network connects devices within a single building or location?

1. WAN
2. LAN ✓ correct
3. MAN
4. VPN

Why: A LAN (Local Area Network) covers one location and is fast/secure. A WAN spans large distances.

12. The internet is the largest example of which type of network?

1. LAN
2. PAN
3. WAN ✓ correct
4. MAN

Why: The internet is a WAN (Wide Area Network) — it connects devices across the entire globe.

13. Which type of memory is VOLATILE (erased when the computer powers off)?

1. ROM
2. RAM ✓ correct
3. The hard drive
4. A flash drive

Why: RAM is temporary working memory that's cleared on shutdown. ROM is permanent, non-volatile memory.

14. A scanner is an example of what kind of device?

1. Output device
2. Input device ✓ correct
3. Storage device
4. Network device

Why: A scanner sends data INTO the computer, so it's an input device (like a keyboard or mouse).

15. Which security tool blocks unauthorized access to a network?

1. A firewall ✓ correct
2. A spreadsheet
3. An OCR scanner
4. A router log

Why: A firewall (hardware or software) blocks unauthorized traffic while allowing legitimate traffic through.

16. A fraudulent email designed to trick you into giving up your password is called:

- 1. Spam
- 2. Phishing ✓ correct**
- 3. Encryption
- 4. A macro

Why: Phishing uses fake emails/sites to steal credentials or financial information.

17. How many bits are in one byte?

- 1. 4
- 2. 8 ✓ correct**
- 3. 16
- 4. 1,024

Why: A byte = 8 bits, and typically stores a single character.

18. According to the law of demand, when the price of a good rises, quantity demanded:

1. Rises
- 2. Falls ✓ correct**
3. Stays exactly the same
4. Becomes unlimited

Why: Law of demand: price and quantity demanded move in opposite directions — the demand curve slopes downward.

19. The price at which quantity supplied equals quantity demanded is called the:

1. Markup price
- 2. Equilibrium price ✓ correct**
3. Break-even price
4. Retail price

Why: At the equilibrium price the market clears — supply equals demand.

20. A market with a SINGLE seller and no close substitutes is a:

1. Oligopoly
- 2. Monopoly ✓ correct**
3. Perfect competition
4. Monopolistic competition

Why: A monopoly has one seller controlling the whole market — maximum price control.

21. A market dominated by a FEW large firms (e.g., airlines) is a(n):

1. Monopoly
- 2. Oligopoly ✓ correct**
3. Perfect competition
4. Cooperative

Why: An oligopoly is dominated by a small number of large firms.

22. Many firms selling similar but differentiated products (restaurants, clothing brands) describes:

1. Monopoly
2. Perfect competition
- 3. Monopolistic competition ✓ correct**
4. Oligopoly

Why: Monopolistic competition = many firms with slightly differentiated products.

23. The value of the next-best alternative you give up when making a choice is called:

1. Sunk cost
- 2. Opportunity cost ✓ correct**
3. Variable cost
4. Fixed cost

Why: Opportunity cost is what you sacrifice — the next-best option not chosen.

24. Which body sets MONETARY policy in the United States?

1. Congress
2. The President
- 3. The Federal Reserve ✓ correct**
4. The FTC

Why: The Federal Reserve controls the money supply and interest rates (monetary policy). Congress handles fiscal policy (taxing/spending).

25. A worker laid off during a recession is experiencing which type of unemployment?

1. Frictional
2. Structural
- 3. Cyclical ✓ correct**
4. Seasonal

Why: Cyclical unemployment is caused by downturns in the business cycle (recessions).

26. GDP measures the output produced:

1. By a country's citizens anywhere in the world
- 2. Within a country's borders ✓ correct**
3. Only by the government
4. Only by exporters

Why: GDP = output within a country's borders. GNP = output by its citizens wherever they are.

27. In a formal meeting, a proposal for the group to take action is called a:

1. Quorum
- 2. Motion ✓ correct**
3. Minute
4. Memo

Why: A motion is a formal proposal; it must be seconded before the group discusses and votes.

28. The number of employees a manager directly supervises is called the:

1. Chain of command
- 2. Span of control ✓ correct**
3. Quorum
4. Org chart

Why: Span of control = how many subordinates report directly to one manager. Wide span = flatter organization.

29. The set of rules (Robert's Rules of Order) for running orderly meetings is called:

- 1. Parliamentary procedure ✓ correct**
2. Due process
3. Chain of command
4. Standard operating procedure

Why: Parliamentary procedure governs motions, seconds, debate, and voting in meetings.

30. Which dress code is one step LESS formal than Business Professional?

1. Business Formal
- 2. Business Casual ✓ correct**
3. Black Tie
4. Athleisure

Why: From most to least formal: Business Formal → Business Professional → Business Casual → Casual.

Career 3 questions

31. Which resume type lists work history in reverse time order (most recent first)?

1. Functional resume
- 2. Chronological resume ✓ correct**
3. Combination resume
4. Reference sheet

Why: A chronological resume lists jobs newest-to-oldest — best for steady, related experience.

32. Which resume is organized by SKILLS and is good for career changers or work gaps?

1. Chronological resume
- 2. Functional resume ✓ correct**
3. Cover letter
4. Portfolio

Why: A functional resume emphasizes skills over dates, helping hide gaps or a career switch.

33. The STAR method structures a behavioral interview answer as:

1. Skills, Training, Awards, References
- 2. Situation, Task, Action, Result ✓ correct**
3. Strengths, Threats, Aims, Roles
4. Start, Try, Adjust, Repeat

Why: STAR = Situation → Task → Action → Result: set the scene, your responsibility, what you did, and the outcome.

Records 2 questions

34. A notation that points to where a record is actually filed is called a:

- 1. Cross-reference ✓ correct**
2. Tickler
3. Abstract
4. Index tab

Why: A cross-reference directs you to the record's real location when it could be filed under more than one name.

35. Filing records by country, state, and city is which filing method?

1. Alphabetic filing
- 2. Geographic filing ✓ correct**
3. Numeric filing
4. Chronological filing

Why: Geographic filing arranges records by location — useful for sales territories or regional offices.

36. The ADDIE instructional-design model stands for:

- 1. Analyze, Design, Develop, Implement, Evaluate ✓ correct**
2. Assess, Deliver, Demo, Inspect, Export
3. Acquire, Define, Decide, Improve, Execute
4. Align, Develop, Document, Iterate, Evaluate

Why: ADDIE = Analyze → Design → Develop → Implement → Evaluate. It builds training; Kirkpatrick evaluates it.

37. Which is the FIRST level of the Kirkpatrick training-evaluation model?

1. Results
2. Behavior
- 3. Reaction ✓ correct**
4. Learning

Why: Order is Reaction → Learning → Behavior → Results. Level 1 measures the learners' immediate reaction.

38. 360-degree feedback gathers performance input from:

1. Only the direct manager
2. Only the employee (self-review)
- 3. Peers, subordinates, managers, and self ✓ correct**
4. An outside consultant only

Why: 360-degree feedback collects views from all around the employee — peers, reports, managers, and self.

39. In Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory, salary and job security are:

1. Motivators that drive satisfaction
- 2. Hygiene factors that prevent dissatisfaction ✓ correct**
3. Self-actualization needs
4. Irrelevant to motivation

Why: Hygiene factors (pay, security, conditions) only prevent dissatisfaction; motivators like recognition and growth drive satisfaction.

40. McGregor's Theory Y assumes that employees:

1. Dislike work and need close supervision
- 2. Are self-motivated and thrive with responsibility ✓ correct**
3. Only work for money
4. Cannot be trained

Why: Theory Y assumes employees are self-motivated and do their best with autonomy; Theory X assumes the opposite.

41. Orientation differs from onboarding in that orientation is:

1. The long, multi-week integration process
- 2. The short initial welcome (paperwork, tour, intros) ✓ correct**
3. A type of performance review
4. Only for managers

Why: Orientation is the brief first-day welcome; onboarding is the longer process of fully ramping a new hire.

42. A 9-box grid plots employees on which two axes?

1. Salary vs tenure
- 2. Performance vs potential ✓ correct**
3. Age vs experience
4. Attendance vs output

Why: The 9-box talent matrix maps current performance against future potential to guide development and succession.

43. Progressive discipline typically begins with:

1. Immediate termination
- 2. A verbal warning ✓ correct**
3. Suspension without pay
4. A demotion

Why: It escalates: verbal warning → written warning → suspension → termination, documented at each step.

44. Which chart shows the distribution of a single CONTINUOUS variable?

1. Bar chart
- 2. Histogram ✓ correct**
3. Pie chart
4. Gantt chart

Why: A histogram bins a continuous variable to show its distribution. A bar chart compares discrete categories.

45. Which chart maps project tasks against a timeline to show schedule and dependencies?

1. Scatter plot
- 2. Gantt chart ✓ correct**
3. Pie chart
4. Area chart

Why: A Gantt chart uses horizontal bars along a timeline to show task durations and dependencies.

46. A chart whose value axis starts above zero can:

1. Make the data more accurate
- 2. Exaggerate differences and mislead the reader ✓ correct**
3. Only be used for pie charts
4. Improve the data-ink ratio

Why: A truncated (non-zero) axis makes small differences look large — always check the scale before concluding.

47. Tufte's 'data-ink ratio' principle says you should:

1. Add 3-D effects and gridlines for emphasis
- 2. Maximize data-conveying ink and remove chartjunk ✓ correct**
3. Use as many colors as possible
4. Always start with a pie chart

Why: Maximize the ink that conveys real data and strip decoration (3-D, heavy gridlines, clutter).

48. The CIA triad in information security stands for:

1. Central, Internal, Access
- 2. Confidentiality, Integrity, Availability ✓ correct**
3. Control, Identity, Authorization
4. Cyber, Internet, Authentication

Why: CIA = Confidentiality (limit access), Integrity (keep data accurate), Availability (keep it accessible).

49. 'Never trust, always verify' best describes which security model?

1. Defense in depth
- 2. Zero Trust ✓ correct**
3. Least privilege
4. Open access

Why: Zero Trust authenticates and authorizes every user/device, even inside the network.

50. A highly targeted phishing attack aimed at a senior executive is called:

1. Spam
2. Spear phishing
- 3. Whaling ✓ correct**
4. Pharming

Why: Whaling targets a 'big fish' executive. Spear phishing targets a specific person; plain phishing is mass-sent.

51. Which encryption uses a public/private KEY PAIR?

1. Symmetric
- 2. Asymmetric ✓ correct**
3. Hashing
4. None — keys are never paired

Why: Asymmetric encryption uses a public key to encrypt and a private key to decrypt. Symmetric uses one shared key.

52. GDPR is the data-privacy law of which jurisdiction?

1. California
- 2. The European Union ✓ correct**
3. Canada
4. Japan

Why: GDPR governs the EU; California's equivalent is the CCPA.
